THE LOST JAMAICAN

BUSH MEDICINE

50 Jamaican Home Remedies



A Heritage of Herbs, Roots & Tradition

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FULL-COLOR ILLUSTRATED EDITION

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Welcome to the Bush

Before there was a pharmacy on every corner, there was the bush. Our family manuscript begins in that yard: a place of plants, kitchen pots, neighbours and knowledge passed from one pair of hands to another.

This illustrated edition keeps that cultural thread. It brings familiar ingredients and household rituals onto the page, with room to see what goes into a pot and what happens at each step.

We have revised the original draft where a title promised too much, a preparation needed better food handling or a traditional quantity could be mistaken for a medical prescription. The change notes at the back explain those choices.

The book celebrates Jamaican and Caribbean home traditions. It does not turn tradition into proof of safety or effectiveness. Keep the stories alive, and keep good judgment beside the chopping board.

Hand to hand, pot to pot, yard to yard.

— The Bush Doctor The Lost Jamaican

Read This First — Straight Talk

This book records Jamaican and Caribbean cultural practices and kitchen preparations. It is not medical advice and does not diagnose, treat, cure or prevent disease. No recipe replaces a doctor, prescribed medicine, urgent care or a proper diagnosis.

A familiar plant is not automatically safe. A traditional quantity is not an established medical dose. Illustrations are interpretive artwork, not plant-identification tools. Do not forage or substitute a plant based on a picture or a common name.

Ask a qualified clinician or pharmacist before herbal use if you take medicines, have a medical condition, are pregnant or breastfeeding, or are preparing something for a child. Do not change or stop medication because of a food or folk practice.

Never give honey to a baby under 12 months, even when it has been heated. Avoid ingredients you are allergic to. Essential oils are not interchangeable with culinary leaves or spices and are not ingredients in the drinks in this edition.

Read This First — continued

Serious or worsening symptoms need medical attention. Difficulty breathing or swallowing, confusion, collapse, chest pain, severe dehydration, or a suspected poisoning require urgent help. Do not delay care while preparing a home remedy.

Wash hands, utensils and produce. Use safe drinking water and labelled food-grade ingredients. Keep raw ingredients and dirty surfaces away from ready-to-eat food.

Cool perishable preparations promptly. Refrigerate at 4°C / 40°F or below. Do not leave them out for more than two hours, or one hour above 32°C / 90°F. The short storage limits in these recipes are conservative household directions, not laboratory shelf-life guarantees.

Handle hot pans and liquids carefully. Let drinks cool to a comfortable temperature. Do not lean over a pot of hot water under a towel: the original steam-inhalation instructions have been removed.

Read the individual caution before each entry. When a preparation is unsuitable for you, leave it out. Good judgment is part of keeping a tradition alive.

How to Use This Book

Each entry has its own two-page spread: the ingredients and main illustration first, followed by numbered preparation steps, use, storage and a full-size caution box.

For this edition, one recipe cup means 250 mL; one tablespoon is 15 mL and one teaspoon is 5 mL. These are kitchen measures, not medicinal doses. Use a scale where grams are given. Do not substitute an 8 US fluid ounce cup as an exact 250 mL measure.

Choose labelled culinary ingredients from a reliable supplier. Jamaican pimento means allspice berries, not chilli or bell peppers. Fresh and dried plants are not universally interchangeable; there is no automatic “half the amount” rule.

Twenty-seven original herbal entries have been replaced with kitchen recipes; twenty-three are revised from the manuscript. Each replacement is identified on its spread. The companion editorial change log maps all 50 original entries to this edition.

Start with the recipes that fit your kitchen and dietary needs. Enjoy food as food; this book gives no daily herbal treatment schedules.

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01 / THE KITCHEN TRADITION

Garlic & Honey

Garlic and honey belong to the home-remedy tradition recorded in this book. Here, they become a carefully prepared kitchen infusion, without a promise to prevent or treat illness.



INGREDIENTS

- 200 g honey
- 20 g fresh garlic, peeled and lightly crushed

01 / PREPARE WITH CARE

From the kitchen



01 Wash your hands and equipment. Peel and lightly crush the garlic; weigh 20 g. Weigh 200 g honey separately. Do not increase the garlic quantity.



02 Warm the honey in the saucepan to at least 60°C / 140°F. Check with a food thermometer.



03 Add the garlic and infuse for 15 minutes, stirring occasionally. Keep the mixture at or above 60°C / 140°F throughout; do not boil or scorch it.



04 Strain while hot to remove the garlic pieces. Transfer to the clean jar and close with its lid.

HOW IT IS USED

Use as a culinary flavoring with food. There is no medicinal dose or cold-prevention schedule for this recipe.

STORAGE

Keep sealed in a clean, food-grade container. Discard if bubbling, mold or a sour odor develops; do not taste a suspect batch.

CAUTION

Never give honey to a baby under 12 months. Do not ferment fresh garlic in honey at room temperature. If you take anticoagulants, aspirin or other medicines, discuss herbal use with your clinician. Avoid ingredients you are allergic to. This preparation is food, not medical treatment.

Read the safety notes on pages 3–4 and the sources at the back.

02 / FROM THE JAMAICAN KITCHEN

Onion & Brown Sugar

A familiar covered bowl from the family manuscript, reframed as a kitchen preparation rather than a cough medicine.



INGREDIENTS

- 1 small onion, peeled
- 3 tablespoons brown sugar

02 / PREPARE WITH CARE

From the kitchen



01 Slice the washed, peeled onion into thin rings.



02 Layer with the sugar in a clean covered bowl. Refrigerate for 6–8 hours.



03 Strain into a clean container. Use as a kitchen condiment; discard after 24 hours.

HOW IT IS USED

Enjoy a modest serving as food or drink, without a treatment schedule.

STORAGE

Make a small batch and enjoy freshly prepared. Refrigerate leftovers promptly at 4°C / 40°F or colder; use within 24 hours. Do not leave perishable food out for more than two hours, or one hour in very hot conditions.

CAUTION

This is a food preparation, not a treatment or a medicinal dose. Avoid any ingredient you are allergic to. If pregnant, nursing, taking medicines or preparing food for a child, check ingredient suitability with a qualified clinician. Never give honey to a baby under 12 months.

Read the safety notes on pages 3–4 and the sources at the back.